

CITA01 – Foundations of City Studies Summer 2026

July 13th, 2026

Course Instructor: Olivia Bernard

Eyes on the
Street - Jacobs

Objectives

Discussion

Jan Gehl and
Outdoor
Spaces

Final Exam

Urban Design
- Whyte

Final Exam



August 20, 2026



2-hour exam



9am – 11am



Quercus Quiz

Final Exam



8 QUESTIONS, CHOOSE 6



CASE STUDIES



MISSED EXAMS WILL
NEED TO GO THROUGH
THE REGISTRAR'S OFFICE

Final Exam



250 WORDS RESPONSES



WORTH 30% OF YOUR
MARKS



DRAW ON COURSE
ARTICLES, VIDEOS AND
LECTURES

Questions?



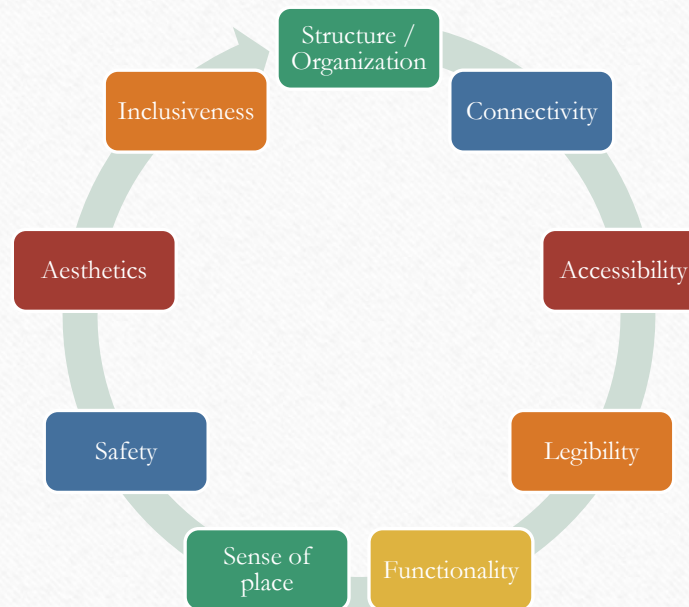
Let us recap – what are some urban design methods used to exclude people in society?

An aerial photograph of a city grid, showing a dense arrangement of buildings and streets. The image is overlaid with a semi-transparent red filter, which serves as the background for the text.

URBAN DESIGN

- The focus is on the design of a site larger than an individual building;
- Urban design looks at the interplay between **streets, parks, open spaces and buildings**;
- Urban design professionals are usually trained in architecture, urban design, landscape architecture or urban planning;
- Urban designers develop designs at multiple scales: sites that include one or more buildings and surrounding open spaces, street blocks, neighbourhoods/communities, parks and public spaces, and entire new towns

ELEMENTS OF GOOD URBAN DESIGN



*HOW CAN A CITY PROMOTE AND IMPLEMENT
GOOD URBAN DESIGN THAT IS INCLUSIVE AND
RESPECT THE RIGHT TO THE CITY?*

THREE TYPES OF OUTDOOR ACTIVITIES (J. GEHL 1987)

When outdoor areas are of poor quality, only strictly necessary activities occur.

When outdoor areas are of high quality, necessary activities take place with approximately the same frequency - though they clearly tend to take a longer time, because the physical conditions are better. In addition, however, a wide range of optional activities will also occur because place and situation now invite people to stop, sit, eat, play, and so on.

In streets and city spaces of poor quality, only the bare minimum of activity takes place. People hurry home.

In a good environment, a completely different, broad spectrum of human activities is possible.

THREE TYPES OF OUTDOOR ACTIVITIES (J. GEHL 1987)

	Quality of the physical environment	
	Poor	Good
Necessary activities		
Optional activities		
"Resultant" activities (Social activities)		

Graphic representation of the relationship between the quality of outdoor spaces and the rate of occurrence of outdoor activities.

When the quality of outdoor areas is good, optional activities occur with increasing frequency. Furthermore, as levels of optional activity rise, the number of social activities usually increases substantially.

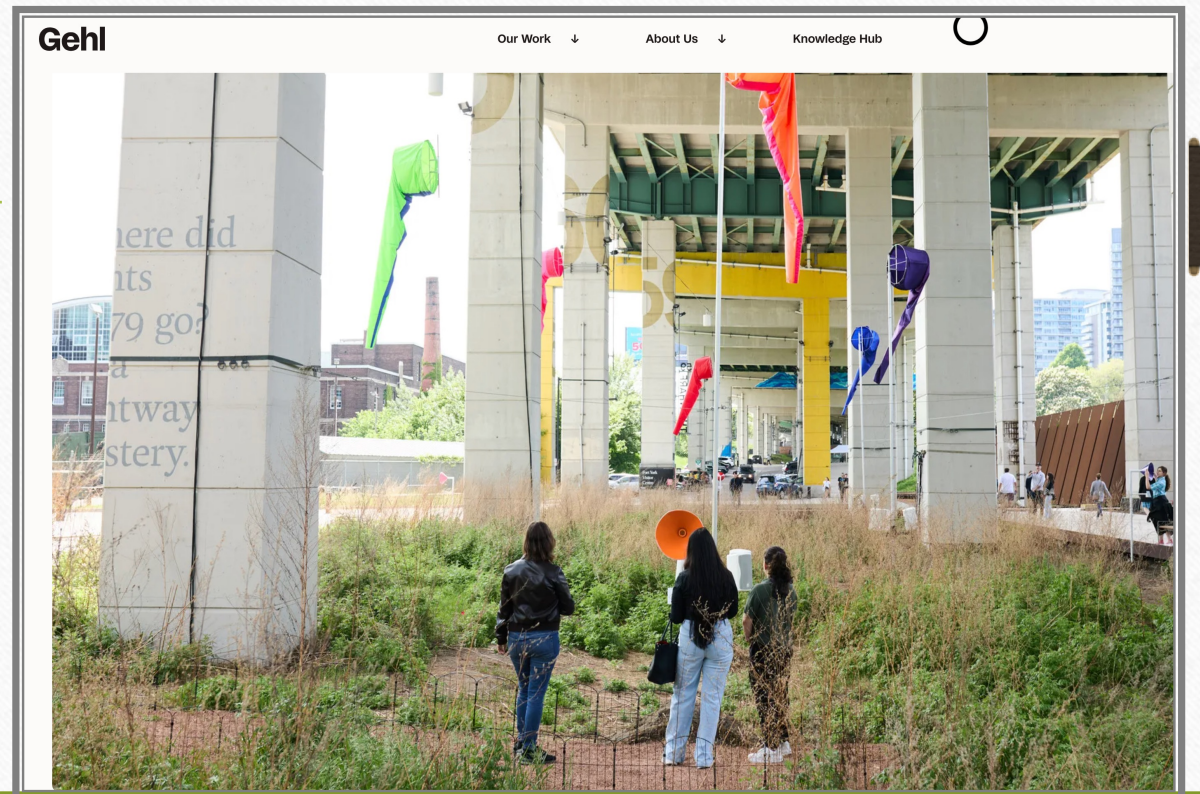


Jan Gehl on Urban Design

- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-PefKxORvA>
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=udHvBzaeWTo>

Strengthening Toronto's public spaces to foster mental and social health

- Let us explore this example
- <https://www.gehlpeople.com/projects/rx-for-social-connection-public-space-as-a-strategy-to-combat-loneliness/>



An aerial photograph of a city, likely New York City, showing a dense grid of buildings and streets. The entire image is covered with a semi-transparent red overlay. The title 'Public Spaces' is centered in the upper half of the image in a black serif font.

Public Spaces

Public space

- Space that is *presumptively* open to all and that all have a right to access
- Defined against private property and private property rules
- Public space increasingly influenced by private interests

Use of Public Spaces

“good spaces: supply creates demand. A good new space builds a new constituency. It gets people into new habits...— and induces them to use new paths”

“The best-used plazas are sociable places, with a higher proportion of couples and groups than you will find in less-used places...If you are alone, a lively place can be the best place to be”.

There needs to be ample seating to draw people in. Some should be moveable.

“This is true of the handicapped also. If a place is planned with their needs in mind, the place is apt to function more easily for everyone...No facilities are segregated. The idea is to make all of the place useful for everyone”.



William Whyte

Women's Use of Public Spaces - Whyte

- “The best-used places also tend to have a higher. than average proportion of women. The male–female ratio of a plaza reflects the composition of the work force and this varies from area to area. In midtown New York it runs about 60 percent male, 40 percent. female. Women are more discriminating than men as to where they will sit, they are more sensitive to annoyances, and they spend more time casing a place. They are also more likely to dust off a ledge with their handkerchief.
- The male–female ratio is one to watch. If a plaza has a markedly low proportion of women, something is wrong. Conversely, if it has a high proportion, the plaza is probably a good and well-managed one and has been chosen as such”.

Time and Location are Important - Whyte

- “The rhythms of plaza life are much alike from place to place. In the morning hours, patronage will be sporadic . . . Around noon the main clientele begins to arrive. Soon activity will be near peak and will stay there until a little before two.
- This means location, and, as the old adage has it, location and location. The space should be in the heart of downtown, close to the 100 percent corner – preferably right on top of it”.

UTSC

01

Which spaces at UTSC do we think are very well designed and invites you to use them?

02

Which areas are poorly designed and do not often get used?

03

Does the design of a space invite you to use it for unintended purposes? Where on campus would this be?



Break - 5 Minutes

An aerial, high-angle photograph of a city street grid, likely in New York City. The image shows a dense arrangement of multi-story brick and stone buildings. A prominent street runs diagonally from the top left towards the bottom right. Another street intersects it perpendicularly in the lower right. The scene is captured in a warm, golden-hour light, with long shadows cast across the rooftops and streets. Several water towers are visible on the rooftops. The text "Do we think streets are important to city life? Why or why not?" is overlaid in a white, serif font, centered horizontally and slightly above the vertical center. A thin white horizontal line is positioned directly beneath the text.

Do we think streets are important
to city life? Why or why not?

Jane Jacobs – Eyes on the Street



“Streets and their sidewalks, the main public places of a city, are its most vital organs.

This is something everyone already knows: A well used city street is apt to be a safe street. A deserted city street is apt to be unsafe”

Streets and their Sidewalks – Jane Jacobs

- “It does not take many incidents of violence on a city street, or in a city district, to make people fear the streets . . . And as they fear them, they use them less, which makes the streets still more unsafe”.

Streets and their Sidewalks – Jane Jacobs

- “The first thing to understand is that the public peace – **the sidewalk and street peace – of cities is not kept primarily by the police**, necessary as police are. It is kept primarily by an intricate, almost unconscious, network of voluntary controls and standards among the people themselves, and enforced by the people themselves.
- The second thing to understand is that the problem of **insecurity cannot be solved by spreading people out more thinly**, trading the characteristics of cities for the characteristics of suburbs”.

Qualities of a well- designed street – Jane Jacobs



There must be a clear demarcation between public and private space – they should not merge.



There must be eyes on the street



The sidewalk must have users present continuously - this will also add to #2 as some people like to people watch

How does eyes on the street work?

“The basic requisite for such surveillance is a substantial quantity of stores and other public places sprinkled along the sidewalks of a district; enterprises and public places that are used by evening and night must be among them especially. Stores, bars and restaurants, as the chief examples, work in several different and complex ways to abet sidewalk safety”.

- People need to have a reason to use the sidewalk and at different times of the day.
- These places will ensure other areas with no attractions get used, since people need to walk to other areas.
- The storekeepers and owners will also aid to keep peace and order – they will also watch the sidewalks
- People moving to and from will also attract those who like to people watch

What makes a street safe?

- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uOLKiOrQB8Y> – watch until 3:05



What Makes a Street Safe? | Jane Jacobs in Death and Life of Great American Cities (1/4)

Discussion

- Please check the tab under the materials for this week on the modules page.
- Upload by the end of class - 1pm.
- Please respond in 120 – 200 words.
- Provide two public areas in Toronto and distinguish between the poorly designed one and the one that invites you to do optional and resultant activities there. Why is one poorly designed vs the other?

Next Steps

Tutorial 5 – July 20th

Sustainability, Resilience, and the Future of Cities

- World Commission on Environment and Development. 2011 [1987]. “Towards Sustainable Development.” Pp. 404-409 in The City Reader
- Calthorpe, Peter. 2015. “Urbanism in the Age of Climate Change.” Pp 511-524 in The City Reader.
- Congress for the New Urbanism 2015 [1993] “Charter for the New Urbanism.” Pp. 410 - 413 in The City Reader.

